

we have made enormous efforts to engage with all of these new and upcoming companies, and that is contributing to meaningful growth for our business.



The renewable energy, semiconductor, and electric vehicle sectors are gaining substantial momentum in India.

How are you contributing to these industries?

These sectors are inherently global in nature whether it comes to technology or interesting business models that India is pioneering but which have also been done in the West. Some of our larger clients are looking to invest in these sectors. That is what is giving us a lot of visibility. We are banking with a number of these companies in their respective operations, and we are now partnering with them as they look to each of these new businesses in India. And this works both in terms of companies as well as investors. Because a lot of capital that is being deployed and invested in a number of these areas is coming in from financial sponsors, infrastructure funds, and private equity, which is again a big area of focus from our perspective.



The Indian start-up ecosystem is thriving. What role do you envision for

yourself in this space?

I actually get most excited about working with start-ups. Typically, companies that J.P. Morgan engages with are a bit more mature in terms of their own journey, probably four or five years old, if not older, and are valued at least about \$500 billion. That's when we start engaging with them. We have two very large teams that cover about 175 companies in the innovation economy. A number of start-ups in India have meaningful international presence; we are working with them on their global banking requirements. We are positioning our business to engage with them across the spectrum of operations—banking, payments, international payments, etc.



Deal activity continues to grow in India. How do you perceive the growth trajectory in this area?

The key theme that we have seen in 2024 is the re-emergence of existing established MNCs on the capital market side who are looking at India as one of the most promising capital-raising locations to further their domestic and international ambitions for growth capital.



Could you provide an overview of the trends in

the initial public offering (IPO) space?

We were really proud to work with both Swiggy and Hyundai on their IPOs. In 2025, the number of IPOs we are actively working on is twice the number that we worked on in 2024. But for us, the main focus is the quality of the business that we want to bring to the market.



As we step into 2025, what excites you the most about the year ahead?

It's a complex external environment that we have to carefully track. But as we look at the next 12 to 18 months, a few things are at play. One is geopolitics and the related impact from trade barriers that are likely to increase. Second is the likely response from countries that are going to be impacted by the trade barriers. On the other hand, if you look at some of the larger contributors to our imports, which is crude oil, its price forecast is softening, which is remarkable for a net importer like India. Other things we will be watching are inflation and jobs in the Indian context, because clearly I think getting inflation to a lower level is important. We then need to look at job creation, in both urban and rural areas, because that is ultimately going to drive consumption

and spending. But our analysts are factoring in a slight slowdown, not just in India but in other Asian countries as well because of all of the geopolitical events into 2025.



Coming to the banking industry, how do you see it navigating the current challenges?

When we look at the regulator and the Indian banking system, I think we are in a very good place, both in terms of capital and the way that the bank managements in India have balanced growth with underwriting standards. Asset growth, I think, is getting to a more manageable pace compared to the past. And credit quality issues are not cropping up in [large] numbers in the larger banks that we are tracking carefully. Indian banks are in a very strong position to support growth for their clients, whether on the wholesale, corporate, or retail side. **BT**

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